April 7, 2026

Nepali Student Association
Morehead State University
Morehead, Kentucky 40351

Office of International Student Services
Morehead State University
234 Adron Doran University Center
Morehead, Kentucky 40351

Dear International Student Services Team,

We, the members and representatives of the Nepali Student Association (NSA) at Morehead State University, write to you with the utmost respect and appreciation for the continued support your office has extended to the international student community. As one of the most actively growing international student groups on campus, we take pride in the contributions our community has made to the diversity and academic richness of this institution. It is in that spirit of shared commitment that we respectfully bring the following concerns to your attention and humbly request your guidance and support.

1. Equal Scholarship Access for Self-Applying Students

We have learned that scholarship opportunities are being communicated differently depending on the application method. Specifically, students applying through recruiting agencies are offered packages such as the **$8,000 international student scholarship + plus a $4,000 housing scholarship, valid for one year**. In contrast, students applying independently may receive only **$8,000** based on strong **ATC/SAT scores**, good high school GPA, and an admissions index of at least **450**.

We respectfully believe that this practice raises serious concerns about equity and fairness. Morehead State University's admissions process is straightforward and accessible, and many prospective students from Nepal are fully capable of completing applications independently. Reserving more generous scholarship packages exclusively for agency applicants creates an unequal playing field for highly qualified self-applying students.

Furthermore, we must respectfully highlight certain troubling practices observed among some recruiting agencies:

- Charging students substantial fees for services they could otherwise perform independently
- Creating email addresses in the student's name without their knowledge, hindering direct university communication

- Providing incomplete or misleading information about academic programs and financial obligations
- Withholding letters of admission and Form I-20 from us the applicants until we pay extra charges
- Continuing to demand additional payments even after visa approval, claiming students must pay "university fees" or fill new forms, often scaring innocent students into paying extra charges

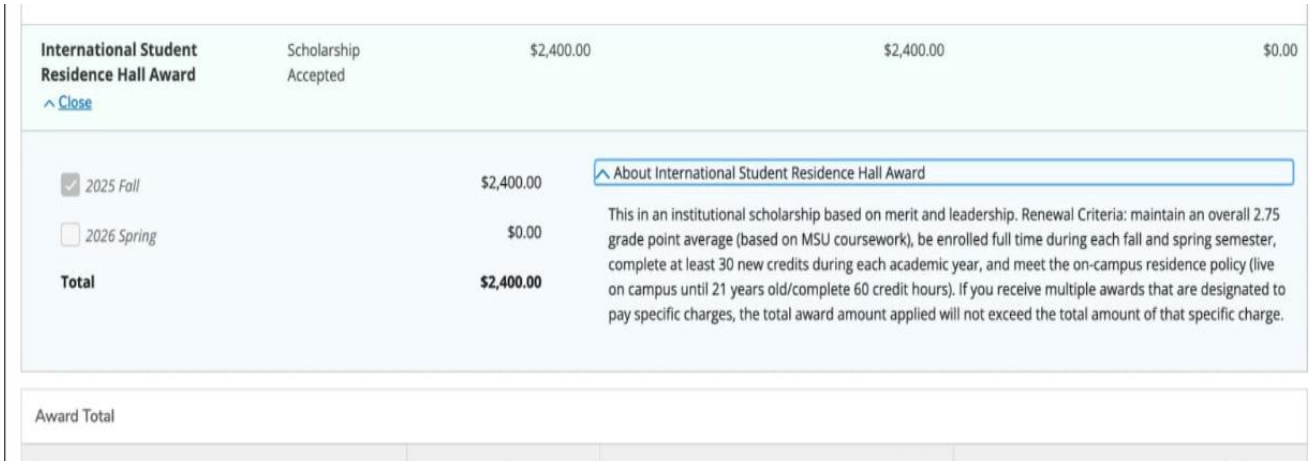
We respectfully request that self-applying students receive equal consideration for the full scholarship packages ($8,000 + $4,000 housing), consistent with agency applicants and the practices of many peer institutions. This would eliminate dependency on agencies, protect students from these additional post-visa charges, ensure fairness, attract the brightest students directly to Morehead State, and align with principles of equal opportunity.

2. Housing Scholarship Renewal after Two Semesters

Our second concern pertains to a matter that has caused considerable distress within our student community and has directly contributed to several students choosing to transfer away from Morehead State University after just one or two semesters.

Many of us chose Morehead State University and made important life decisions back in Nepal based on the housing scholarship information we found on the official university student portal. It clearly stated that housing scholarships would be available for two semesters and renewable based on merit, leadership, full-time enrollment, and maintaining a 2.75 GPA. However, we have recently learned that this scholarship has not been renewed or implemented as originally communicated (screenshot attached for reference).

We respectfully request that the University honor this commitment as originally presented to students who planned their education and moved to Morehead State based on this specific information.



International Student Residence Hall Award ^ Close	Scholarship Accepted	$2,400.00	$2,400.00	$0.00

2025 Fall	$2,400.00
2026 Spring	$0.00
Total	**$2,400.00**

^ About International Student Residence Hall Award

This in an institutional scholarship based on merit and leadership. Renewal Criteria: maintain an overall 2.75 grade point average (based on MSU coursework), be enrolled full time during each fall and spring semester, complete at least 30 new credits during each academic year, and meet the on-campus residence policy (live on campus until 21 years old/complete 60 credit hours). If you receive multiple awards that are designated to pay specific charges, the total award amount applied will not exceed the total amount of that specific charge.

Award Total

3. Meal Plan Waiver Flexibility for Dietary, Cultural, and Religious Needs

Our third concern relates to meal plan requirements and the limited flexibility currently afforded to students with dietary restrictions arising from cultural background, religious observance, or medical necessity.

As students who have grown up in Nepal, many members of our community maintain dietary practices deeply rooted in culture and faith including vegetarian, vegan, halal, or other specific dietary requirements that are not consistently or adequately accommodated by the current campus dining options. For some of our students, this is not merely a matter of preference, but a genuine concern affecting their physical health, mental well-being, and spiritual practice.

We primarily chose Morehead State University because we were informed through recruiting agencies that MSU provides meal plan flexibility, allowing international students to cook their own ethnic food and follow their preferred dietary practices. This was one of the main reasons we selected MSU over other universities.

Many Nepali students have specific cultural, health, and religious dietary needs that are difficult to accommodate through standard meal plans. We respectfully request that the University continue and formalize this meal plan flexibility policy as originally communicated through agencies, enabling students to prepare their own meals as promised.

4. International Transport Fee Concerns

We would also like to raise concern about the **International Transport Fee** charged to all international students each semester. We understand this fee is intended to cover airport pickup services for new students arriving at the beginning of their studies. However, continuing students (particularly those here for more than two semesters) do not use or need this service.

Many international students have expressed disappointment about being required to pay this fee despite not utilizing the service. **We respectfully request flexibility on this charge that students who do not need airport pickup be allowed to opt out and not have this fee applied to their accounts.** This would be fairer for students who make their own travel arrangements.

We wish to express, once again, our sincere gratitude for everything the International Office and the PDSO have done and continue to do in support of international students at Morehead State University. The care and guidance your office has consistently provided has not gone unnoticed by our community, and we are genuinely thankful.

The concerns raised in this letter are shared by a large number of our members and are submitted in good faith with the sincere hope of fostering a stronger, more equitable, and supportive environment for all

international students. We look forward to the opportunity to discuss these matters further at your earliest convenience and remain open to any dialogue that would help bring about a positive resolution.

Respectfully yours,

Nepali Student Association (NSA)
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